Education Agency - BI & Business Analysis Report

A systematic walkthrough of the agency's six-dashboard Power BI suite. Each dashboard is read in turn - what it shows, what it means for the business, the issues visible in it, and how to fix them -followed by cross-cutting findings and recommendations. Figures are read from the dashboards at a 22 September 2026 snapshot.

Executive summary

The six dashboards tell one story: the agency has plenty of cheap leads and a strong back end, but it loses most of its value in the middle of the journey and collects only half of what it earns. End to end, **6% of leads become arrived students** (1,000 → 60).

Dashboard	Headline it delivers
Executive Overview	1,000 leads → 60 arrivals; €174.4K earned, €88.4K collected
Lead & Marketing	169 campaign leads at €38.14 CPL; 83% of leads are organic
Admissions	52% offer rate per application; 67% of applicants get an offer
Visa	90% approval rate; only half of cases decided
Case Tracking	861 active, 79 lost, 60 completed
Finance & Operations	50.68% collection rate; €68.9K outstanding

Three decisions carry the most value: attack the top of the funnel (most leads are lost before they apply), run commission collection as a managed process (half the earned money is uncollected), and protect the organic/referral channels that already supply most leads cheaply. The dashboards are well built and now internally consistent; the issues noted per dashboard are mostly presentation and interpretation fixes, not data errors.

Business understanding and objectives

The agency recruits Burmese students into Irish universities and earns revenue from **commissions paid by partner universities** when a recruited student enrols -not from fees charged to students. Revenue is therefore realised only at the end of a long journey, so every student who drops out early is lost effort and lost income.

The core business problem is **journey leakage**: prospects enter at the top of a twelve-stage pipeline (New Lead through Consultation, Application, Offer, Visa, Arrival) and can exit at any point. Management needs to see, in one place, how many leads are lost, where, and what the surviving pipeline is worth.

The BI system exists to answer exactly that. Its six dashboards are not independent reports; each is a different view of the same end-to-end process, from marketing spend at the top to collected commission at the bottom. This report reads them in that order.

Approach and data

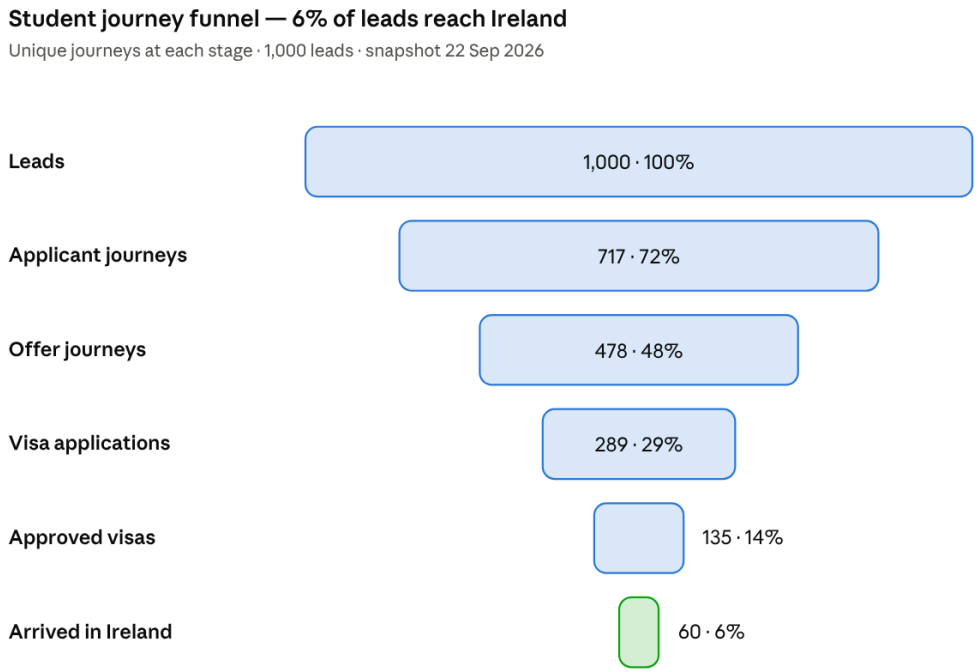
The analysis sits on seven linked tables -students, consultants, marketing campaigns, student journeys, university applications, visa applications and university commissions -cleaned and validated in Python, modelled in PostgreSQL, and visualised in Power BI with DAX.

Two things to keep in mind when reading the dashboards. All figures are a **single snapshot at 22 September 2026**, so they describe current state, not trends through time. The data is **synthetic**; commission rates and tuition are modelled assumptions, so revenue figures are realistic in shape but are not booked accounts.

Each dashboard below is read in a consistent four-part structure: **what it shows**, **business understanding** (what it means), **issues** (what to watch in the data or the visual), and **possible solutions**.

Dashboard 1 -Executive Overview

What it shows. The management cockpit, grouped into Growth (1,000 leads, 861 active cases, 79 lost), Conversion (717 applicant journeys, 64.2% lead-to-submitted-application, 90% visa approval) and Commercial (€174.42K earned, €88.40K collected, €202.87K forecast commission). Below the cards sit the student journey funnel, a lead trend with month-on-month change, a financial pipeline by month, leads by acquisition source, and commercial partner performance by university.



student journey funnel · the Executive Overview centrepiece

Business understanding. This page answers the CEO's first question -is the business growing and converting? The funnel is the key exhibit: it shows the 6% end-to-end conversion and that losses are

spread across the journey, heaviest before application. The commercial cards show a healthy earned figure but collection running at roughly half.

Issues. Several card and section titles are truncated ("CONVERSION &", "Commission Colle…", "Forecast Commissi…"), which looks unfinished. The Financial Pipeline stacks "Earned Commission" alongside "Invoiced Outstanding" and "Overdue" -but Invoiced and Overdue are *part of* Earned, so that stack double-counts. The Year slicer only lists 2025–2026 (lead years), which could confuse a reader who expects intake years.

Possible solutions. Widen the cards or shorten the measure names so titles fit. Rebuild the Financial Pipeline on the five mutually exclusive commission statuses (Paid, Invoiced, Overdue, Earned-not-invoiced, Forecast) so the segments sum without overlap. Relabel the slicer as "Lead Year" and confirm the MoM line is on a secondary percentage axis.

Dashboard 2 -Lead & Marketing Analysis

What it shows. Acquisition KPIs (1,000 leads, 1,000 unique students, 861 active, 79 lost, 7.9% lost-case rate, €6.45K marketing spend, 169 campaign leads), a monthly lead trend, leads by source (Website, TikTok, Student Referral and Google leading), a case-status donut (86.1% active, 7.9% lost, 6% completed), a campaign table with budget, spend and cost per lead (totals: €9,151 budget, €6,446 spend, €38.14 CPL), and a lead-to-application rate by source.

Business understanding. Acquisition is cheap and organic. Website, referral and social supply the bulk of leads, while paid campaigns account for only 169 of 1,000. The lost-case rate of 7.9% is low, so the problem is not losing leads outright -it is failing to convert the ones that stay active.

Issues. The lead-to-application rate ranks Education Event highest (~0.9), but that source has only a handful of leads -a small-sample artefact that can mislead. The `lead_source` field mixes paid platforms with organic sources (Facebook and Instagram appear as both), so paid-versus-organic cannot be cleanly separated. CPL describes only the 17% of leads that are campaign-attributed, not acquisition overall.

Possible solutions. Add a minimum-volume threshold (or show lead counts beside the rate) so low-volume sources don't top the conversion chart. Add an `is_campaign` flag and keep the original organic source in its own column to separate paid from organic. Label CPL clearly as campaign-only, not blended.

Dashboard 3 -University Admission & Application Tracking

What it shows. Admissions KPIs (1,118 applications, 717 applicant journeys, 583 offers, 154 rejected, 52.15% offer rate, 64.2% lead-to-submitted-application), applications by university and by course, an application-status donut (Offer Issued 52.15%, Rejected 13.77%, Documents Pending 12.88%, Under Review 10.91%, Submitted 10.29%), an Application Outcome Display bar (Offer 583, Pending/No Final Outcome 381, Rejected 154), and a university-by-status matrix totalling 1,118.

Business understanding. Students lodge about 1.56 applications each and spread them fairly evenly across the partner universities. The 52% offer rate is per application; at the applicant level, 67% of applicants secure at least one offer -the gap is the payoff of multiple applications. This is the agency's strongest conversion lever.

Issues. The headline “Offer Rate 52.15%” is per-application and understates applicant success; a reader may take it as the chance a student gets an offer. The dashboard already handles blank outcomes correctly via the Application Outcome Display field, which is good practice.

Possible solutions. Add an applicant-level KPI card -“Applicant Offer Success 66.7%” -beside the per-application rate so both readings are explicit. Keep the university-by-status matrix; it is the most actionable visual here for spotting weak partners.

Dashboard 4 -Visa Analysis

What it shows. Visa KPIs (90% approval rate, 135 approved, 15 refused, 65 pending, 28.9% lead-to-visa, 44.44% approval-to-arrival), a visa-outcome bar, a visa-status donut (Approved 46.71%, Preparing 25.61%, Pending Decision 22.49%, Refused 5.19%), visa cases by university, by intake term (September leading), and by consultant (54–65 cases each).

Business understanding. Visas are a strength, not a bottleneck. Among decided cases the approval rate is 90%, confirming that students reaching this stage are well-prepared. The 44.44% approval-to-arrival figure looks low but mostly reflects timing -75 of the 135 approved students had not yet arrived at the snapshot, not that they were lost.

Issues. The visa-outcome bar and the visa-status donut present almost the same breakdown twice, which wastes space. The consultant chart shows near-identical counts (54–65) and invites a performance reading it can't support -it is workload, not outcome. The 44.44% approval-to-arrival card can be misread as leakage.

Possible solutions. Keep one status visual (the donut) and replace the duplicate with something new -e.g. visa processing stage over time, or refusals by university. Relabel the consultant chart as “Visa Caseload by Consultant”. Add a short note or tooltip that approval-to-arrival is depressed by students still in transit at the snapshot.

Dashboard 5 -Student Case Tracking

What it shows. An operational view: KPI cards (1,000 unique students, 861 active, 79 lost, 60 successful journeys) over a full case detail table -student, consultant, lead date, source, intake term and year, current stage and case status -with slicers for student name, stage, case status, intake year, term, consultant and source.

Business understanding. This is the consultants' working screen, used to find and action individual cases rather than to analyse. It lets a consultant filter to their own active cases or to a stage that needs attention. The intake-year field now displays correctly as years (e.g. 2027, 2028) rather than being summed, so the filter behaves as expected.

Issues. The page is almost entirely a detail table and slicers; there is no visual of how cases are distributed across stages, so a manager can't see at a glance where cases pile up. And because the data holds no stage-change history, the screen shows the *current* stage but not how long a case has sat there -the single most useful operational signal is missing.

Possible solutions. Add a current-stage bar or funnel at the top so the stage distribution reads at a glance, plus a small consultant-caseload summary. Time-in-stage requires a case-events table (stage-change timestamps), which is the priority data extension for turning this from a lookup screen into a management tool.

Dashboard 6 -Finance & Operations

What it shows. Finance KPIs (€174.42K earned, €88.40K collected, €202.87K forecast, €68.94K outstanding, 50.68% collection rate, €167.98K contribution after marketing), a monthly earned-commission trend, earned commission by partner tier (Gold €78K, Platinum €43K, Silver €34K, Bronze €20K) and by university (Galway leading at ~€30K), average commission per university, commission by status, a revenue-type split (Forecast 55.56%, Earned 44.44%) and a consultant operations table.

Business understanding. This is the money view, and its message is collection, not earning. Half of earned commission (€88.4K of €174.4K) is in the bank; €68.9K is outstanding. Gold-tier universities generate the most total commission while Platinum partners pay the most per student. Contribution after marketing (€167.98K) is correctly kept distinct from profit, since operating costs are not modelled.

Issues. The monthly earned-commission trend is very spiky at the right-hand end because it plots at daily granularity near the snapshot, where earned dates cluster. The commission-by-status chart mixes Forecast (≈€0.2M) with the much smaller earned statuses, so Forecast visually dominates. Consultant arrival and earned figures rest on only 10–11 arrivals each, too few to rank performance. A few chart titles are truncated.

Possible solutions. Aggregate the trend to calendar month so it reads as a clean line. Either split Forecast into its own visual or clearly label the status chart as the full pipeline. Treat the consultant table as workload and directional revenue, not a league table, until arrival counts grow. Widen or shorten the truncated titles.

Cross-dashboard findings

Read together, the six dashboards tell a story no single page shows:

- **The constraint is conversion, not visas.** Marketing (Dashboard 2) delivers leads cheaply and Visa (Dashboard 4) approves 90% of decided cases, yet the Overview funnel (Dashboard 1) shows only 6% arrive. The loss is in the middle -Admissions (Dashboard 3) -where leads must become applicants and win offers.
- **Two separate pipelines.** The journey pipeline (Dashboards 1–5) and the money pipeline (Dashboard 6) leak independently. A student can arrive while the commission stays unpaid; today about half the earned money is uncollected.
- **Volume is abundant, conversion and collection are scarce.** Leads are plentiful and 83% organic, so the binding resource is consultant capacity to convert and finance capacity to collect -not more marketing spend.
- **The data is now consistent.** The visa refusals that were previously missing are present (15 refused, 90% approval), so the Overview, Visa and Finance pages agree with each other and with the underlying tables.

Consolidated issues and solutions

The issues raised per dashboard, gathered and prioritised. These are presentation and interpretation fixes -the underlying data is sound.

Dashboard	Issue	Solution	Priority
Executive	Financial pipeline stacks Earned with its own sub-totals (double-counts)	Rebuild on the five mutually exclusive statuses	High
Executive	Truncated card/section titles	Widen cards or shorten measure names	Medium
Executive	Year slicer (2025–26) could be mistaken for intake year	Relabel as “Lead Year”	Low
Lead & Marketing	Lead-to-application rate topped by a tiny-volume source	Add a volume threshold or show counts	Medium
Lead & Marketing	Source field mixes paid and organic	Add `is_campaign` flag; keep organic source	Medium
Admissions	Offer rate shown per-application only	Add applicant-level offer-success KPI (66.7%)	Medium
Visa	Outcome bar and status donut duplicate each other	Keep one; use the space for a new view	Medium
Visa	Approval-to-arrival (44%) reads as leakage	Annotate as timing at the snapshot	Low
Case Tracking	No stage-distribution visual; no time-in-stage	Add a stage funnel; add case-events data	High
Finance	Monthly trend spiky (daily granularity)	Aggregate to calendar month	Medium
Finance	Consultant table invites a performance ranking	Label as caseload; treat revenue as directional	Low

Business recommendations

1. **Fix the top of the funnel first.** The largest single loss is the 283 leads who never apply. Focus consultant follow-up and document support on the consultation-to-application step.
2. **Push a second application.** Applicants who apply twice convert far better (67% of applicants get an offer vs 52% of applications). Make a second well-matched application the default.
3. **Run collection as a managed process.** €68,945 is earned but uncollected and much of it overdue. Assign an owner, invoice the earned-but-not-invoiced balance, and chase overdue accounts on a schedule.

4. **Protect and grow organic/referral.** These supply 83% of leads at near-zero cost. Formalise a referral programme before scaling paid spend, and verify paid campaigns out-convert organic at their €38 CPL.
5. **Prioritise high-value partners.** Gold-tier universities (Galway, UCC) and Platinum partners drive the most commission -weight placement effort toward them where the student fit is right.
6. **Clear the visa decision backlog.** Only half of visa cases are decided; with a 90% approval rate, moving them through is low-risk revenue acceleration.
7. **Add event-level tracking.** A case-events table with stage-change timestamps would turn the dashboards from measuring *where* leakage happens into diagnosing *why* and *how long* -the biggest single upgrade to the BI system.

Limitations

- The dataset is synthetic; distributions may not match a real agency.
- Commission rates and tuition are modelled assumptions, so revenue figures are indicative, not booked.
- All figures are a single snapshot, so the dashboards show state, not trends over time.
- There is no stage-change or contact history, so no time-in-stage, processing-duration or follow-up analysis is possible.
- Only 17% of leads are campaign-attributed, limiting channel-economics conclusions.
- Operating costs are not modelled, so contribution after marketing is not profit.

Conclusion

The six-dashboard suite does its job: it turns a messy multi-table dataset into a connected, end-to-end view of the recruitment business, and it answers the questions management actually asks -where are leads lost, how good is conversion, and how much money is earned and collected. The data is now internally consistent across all pages.

The story the dashboards tell is clear and actionable. The agency does not need more leads or a better visa process; it needs to convert the leads it already has and collect the commission it has already earned. The issues noted per dashboard are refinements to presentation and interpretation, not flaws in the analysis -addressing them, and adding event-level data, would take a strong BI system to an excellent one.